



# ENGLISH IN CHAPTERS

A Simple, Easy-to-Follow Grammar Course

**Level B2 • Upper-Intermediate**

*12 chapters • 3 examples per topic • appendix with further reading*

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**Appendix.** Further Reading

## Chapter 1. Verb Tenses – The Full System

English builds its tenses from three time frames (present, past, future) and four aspects (simple, continuous, perfect, perfect continuous), plus the active and passive voice.

| Tense                      | Form                  | Use                                 |
|----------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Present Simple             | eat / eats            | habits, facts, routines             |
| Present Continuous         | am/is/are + V-ing     | now, temporary situations           |
| Present Perfect            | have/has + V3         | past action with a present result   |
| Present Perfect Continuous | have/has been + V-ing | action continuing up to now         |
| Past Simple                | V2                    | finished action in the past         |
| Past Continuous            | was/were + V-ing      | action in progress in the past      |
| Past Perfect               | had + V3              | the earlier of two past actions     |
| Future Simple              | will + V              | predictions, spontaneous decisions  |
| Future Continuous          | will be + V-ing       | action in progress in the future    |
| Passive Voice              | be + V3 (any tense)   | focus on the action, not who did it |

### 3 Examples

- *I have lived here since 2015. (present perfect – the situation continues)*
- *By the time we arrived, the film had already started. (past perfect – the earlier action)*
- *The report will be finished by Friday. (future passive – the task matters more than who does it)*

**Tip:** Use "since" with a point in time and "for" with a duration when a perfect tense is used: since 2015 / for six years.

## Chapter 2. Prepositions – Full Reference

Prepositions of place, time, and movement link nouns to the rest of the sentence. B2 English uses a wider, more precise set than the basics.

| Category | Common prepositions                    |
|----------|----------------------------------------|
| Place    | above, between, beyond, beneath, among |
| Time     | since, during, until, throughout, by   |

| Category | Common prepositions                 |
|----------|-------------------------------------|
| Movement | through, across, into, onto, toward |

### 3 Examples

- *The negotiations continued throughout the night.*
- *She has worked here since 2019.*
- *He walked through the crowd toward the exit.*

## Chapter 3. Adverbs – Position & Type

At B2, adverb position becomes a precision tool. Manner adverbs usually go after the verb; frequency adverbs sit before the main verb; time adverbs often go at the front or end.

| Type            | Typical position        | Example                       |
|-----------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Frequency       | before the main verb    | She often arrives early.      |
| Manner          | after the verb / object | He worked hard in the garden. |
| Sentence adverb | front, with a comma     | Fortunately, nobody was hurt. |

### 3 Examples

- *She often arrives early.*
- *He worked hard in the garden yesterday to finish the project.*
- *Fortunately, nobody was hurt.*

**Tip:** Golden rule for multiple adverbs in one sentence: Manner → Place → Time → Purpose.

## Chapter 4. Comparative & Superlative Structures

Beyond -er/-est, B2 English compares using as...as, less/least, and separate quantity words for countable and uncountable nouns.

| Structure             | Use                         | Example                    |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------|
| as...as / not as...as | show equality or inequality | not as strong as last year |
| fewer + countable     | compare countable nouns     | fewer clients              |

| Structure          | Use                       | Example   |
|--------------------|---------------------------|-----------|
| less + uncountable | compare uncountable nouns | less debt |

### 3 Examples

- *This year's sales are not as strong as last year's.*
- *We have fewer clients than our competitor, but less debt.*
- *He is by far the most experienced manager in the department.*

## Chapter 5. Possessive 's vs. Noun-as-Adjective

Use 's when something belongs to one specific person or thing. Use a noun as an adjective (no 's) for a general category or type — this is often the more natural, professional choice.

### 3 Examples

- *The employee's performance was excellent. (one specific person)*
- *We review annual employee performance. (a general category)*
- *The company's profit increased. (one specific, named company)*

**Tip:** Quick test: if you can replace the phrase with "of the [specific thing]", use 's. If it means "for/related to [things in general]", drop the 's.

## Chapter 6. Possessive Pronouns & the Genitive

Possessive pronouns stand alone and replace a full possessive phrase. The genitive ("of") can also express relationships that go beyond simple ownership.

### 3 Examples

- *Whose idea was this? — It was hers.*
- *The final decision is theirs to make.*
- *A colleague of mine recommended this book.*

## Chapter 7. Linking Words – Contrast, Cause, Addition, Conclusion

More advanced connectors let you organize longer, more formal writing and speech clearly.

| Function       | Examples                             |
|----------------|--------------------------------------|
| Contrast       | however, although, whereas           |
| Cause & effect | therefore, as a result, consequently |
| Addition       | furthermore, in addition, moreover   |
| Conclusion     | in conclusion, to sum up, overall    |

### 3 Examples

- *Although the budget was tight, the project succeeded.*
- *Sales dropped; as a result, the team revised its strategy.*
- *In conclusion, the new policy benefits both staff and customers.*

## Chapter 8. Gerunds vs. Infinitives

Some verbs and all prepositions are followed by the "-ing" form (gerund). Other verbs are followed by "to + verb" (infinitive) — and a few change meaning depending on which you choose.

### 3 Examples

- *I look forward to hearing from you. (preposition + gerund)*
- *We decided to postpone the meeting. (verb + infinitive)*
- *Avoiding conflict rarely solves the real problem. (gerund as subject)*

## Chapter 9. Participial Adjectives (-ed / -ing)

-ed adjectives describe how someone feels. -ing adjectives describe the person, thing, or situation that causes that feeling.

### 3 Examples

- *The presentation was confusing, so the audience felt confused.*
- *Investors were excited about the exciting new product launch.*
- *The delayed flight left passengers frustrated and exhausted.*

## Chapter 10. Nouns as Adjectives — Choosing the Right Form

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In professional English, a noun used as an adjective is often more natural than the possessive form, especially for categories, departments, and product types.

### 3 Examples

- *Customer service must improve this quarter.*
- *The driver's license renewal took two weeks. (one specific document)*
- *Our product research shows strong demand.*

## Chapter 11. Professional & Business Verbs

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Precise verbs make professional communication clearer and more confident than generic ones like "do" or "make".

| Verb               | Meaning                           |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------|
| implement          | put a plan or system into action  |
| negotiate          | discuss to reach an agreement     |
| streamline         | make a process simpler and faster |
| delegate           | give a task to someone else       |
| address (an issue) | deal with a problem directly      |

### 3 Examples

- *The team will implement the new system next month.*
- *Managers should delegate routine tasks to junior staff.*
- *We need to address these concerns before the deadline.*

## Chapter 12. Synonyms for Precision

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Choosing the right synonym avoids repetition and signals a wider vocabulary — useful for verbs, adjectives, and linking words alike.

### 3 Examples

- *increase* → *rise, grow, boost*
- *important* → *crucial, essential, significant*
- *show* → *demonstrate, indicate, reveal*

## Appendix — Further Reading

*One or more trusted links for every chapter, in case you want to go deeper into a topic.*

### Chapter 1. Verb Tenses – The Full System

- [Present Simple – explained](#)
- [Past Simple – form & use](#)
- [Passive voice practice](#)
- [All tenses – free cheat sheet \(PDF\)](#)

### Chapter 2. Prepositions – Full Reference

- [Prepositions of time: at, in, on](#)

### Chapter 3. Adverbs – Position & Type

- [Adverbs – Cambridge Grammar guide](#)

### Chapter 4. Comparative & Superlative Structures

- [Adjectives & adverbs – Cambridge Grammar](#)

### Chapter 5. Possessive 's vs. Noun-as-Adjective

- [Possessive 's – British Council](#)

### Chapter 6. Possessive Pronouns & the Genitive

- [Possessive pronouns – practice](#)

### Chapter 7. Linking Words – Contrast, Cause, Addition, Conclusion

- [Linking words – full list](#)
- [Conclusion starters](#)

### Chapter 8. Gerunds vs. Infinitives

- [Grammar reference hub – Cambridge](#)

### Chapter 9. Participial Adjectives (-ed / -ing)

- [Adjectives ending -ed / -ing](#)

### Chapter 10. Nouns as Adjectives — Choosing the Right Form

- [Grammar reference hub – Cambridge](#)

### Chapter 11. Professional & Business Verbs

- [Grammarly blog – vocabulary & writing](#)

### Chapter 12. Synonyms for Precision

- [Thesaurus.com – find synonyms](#)